

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ Q J 10

♥ 4 2

♦ K J 7 4 3 2

♣ 9 3

♠ A K 5 3

♥ Q 10

♦ Q 6 5

♣ A 7 4 2



♠ 8 7 6 2

♥ A 7 5

♦ A 9

♣ K Q J 10

♠ 9 4

♥ K J 9 8 6 3

♦ 10 8

♣ 8 6 5

West

North

East

South

1NT

Pass

2♦

Pass

2♥

All Pass

2♥ by North

North opens 1NT.

With 6 ♥s of your own you can be sure that your side has at least an 8-card ♥ fit. So playing ♥s will be better than playing notrump. You bid 2♦, transferring partner to ♥s. Partner says 2♥.

Of course you pass. You only have 6 points so there is no chance for game. You just wanted to reach the best partscore and figured 2♥ would be safer than 1NT.

As you can see from partner's hand you made the right call. Played in ♥s your hand will produce five tricks. At notrump your hand will win only one trick if the defenders hold up their ♥A just one time.

Board 3

South Deals

E-W Vul

♠ A J 3
 ♥ J 10 9 3 2
 ♦ A 7 2
 ♣ 8 6

♠ Q 8 7 6 4

♥ Q 4

♦ K 6 3

♣ J 9 2



♠ 9 2
 ♥ K 8 7 6
 ♦ 10 9 5
 ♣ A 10 5 4

♠ K 10 5

♥ A 5

♦ Q J 8 4

♣ K Q 7 3

West	North	East	South
			1NT
Pass	2♥	Pass	2♠
Pass	2NT	Pass	3♠
All Pass			

3♠ by South

You might revalue your hand up to 10 points now that an 8-card fit has been discovered, but it is a really poor 10 points. Also, remember the warning about Responder revaluing for short suits.

As you can see, a 4♠ contract would have no chance, losing 1 trick in each side suit and at least 1 ♠.

South's 1NT opening shows 15-17 points. What is your bid?

With 9 points you have an invitational strength hand. With a 5-card ♠ suit you should transfer partner to ♠s by bidding 2♥. Partner dutifully responds 2♠.

With this next bid you must tell partner you only have invitational strength, and inform him that you have only 5 ♠s (remember, your transfer promised **AT LEAST** 5). The bid that says both of these facts at once is 2NT. Partner comes back with 3♠. What say you?

You say pass. Partner did not accept your invitation to game so he must have a minimum hand. His correction to 3♠ indicates he has three of the suit and wants to play in ♠s rather than notrump.